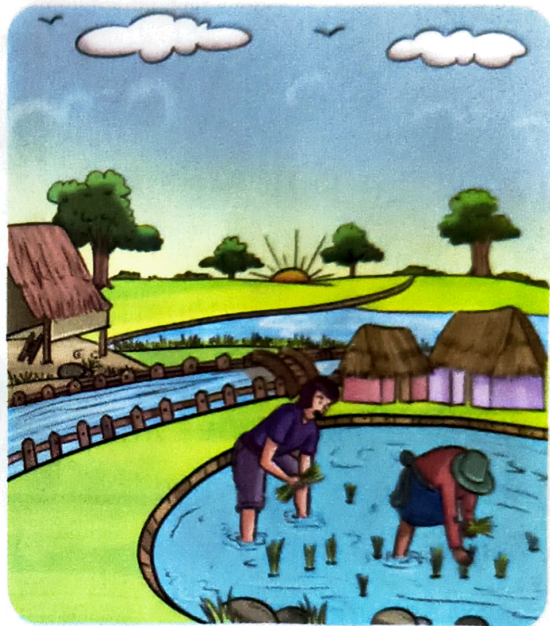
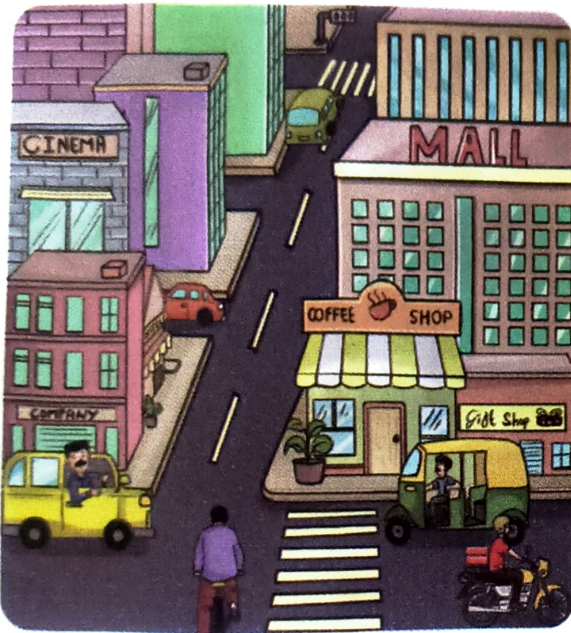




A Visit to Mawlynnong

Here We Go!

Look at the pictures carefully.



Discuss with your partner and write down two differences between life in a city and life in a village.



City Life

Village Life

1.

2.



Let's Read

Read the letter written by Janvi to her friend Seher describing a small village in Meghalaya, and what makes it so special.

B-1/480 Lajpat Nagar

New Delhi

5 July 20XX

Dear Seher,

We are just back from our vacation in Meghalaya. We had the most wonderful time. I have always enjoyed city life, but had no idea what it would be like to live in the village.



Let me tell you about Mawlynnong, the village we visited.

Mawlynnong is a small village in Meghalaya. In 2003, it was declared the cleanest village in Asia.

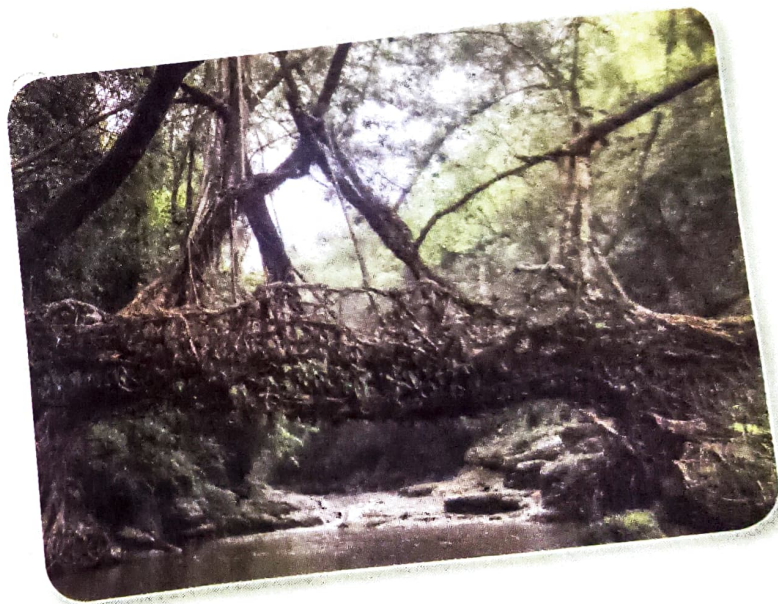
When we reached the village, I was very **impressed**. This village is one of the most beautiful villages I have seen. It is **spotlessly** clean!

The villagers greeted us warmly and took us to the guest house. On both sides of the street were **thatched** huts with gardens full of colourful flowers. There were bamboo baskets outside every house, to be used as bins.

The guest house where we stayed was made of bamboo. It was on **stilts**, so I felt as if I was in a tree house. There were two bedrooms, a living room and a verandah. There was a **machan** where we sat

and enjoyed the greenery of the forest. There was a gentle gurgling waterfall in the background. I had my lunch on the *machan* and just wanted to laze there, but dad said it was time to go and see the Living Root Bridge.

After a 30-minute walk downhill, I saw the strangest natural bridges over a stream. These bridges have been made by **twisting** the roots of big rubber trees. These root bridges are unique to Meghalaya. All around Cherrapunji there are several such bridges **fashioned** by Khasi villagers who have, over decades, woven the roots of rubber trees across **rivulets** and streams.

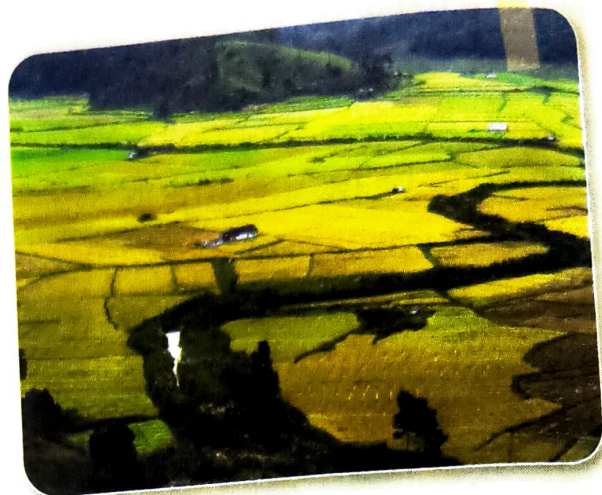


Another interesting thing the villagers have constructed here is the Sky View. This is a high viewing tower that's made of bamboo. Dad and I climbed up the steps to the top, mummy stayed below

with Shray, who is afraid of heights. When I reached the top, I could see the village and the rice fields not just in India, but also Bangladesh on the other side of the border.

After a simple meal of lentils, rice and potatoes, we went to bed early.

The next morning, as we walked around the village, I saw that tidying up is something that everyone takes very seriously. Before going to school, young children sweep the village and empty the dustbins. I made friends with a girl of my age – 11-year-old Deity Bakordor. I asked Deity if she was happy to live in such a clean place. She nodded, shyly. I asked her what would she do if a visitor dropped rubbish on the ground. She replied that she wouldn't say anything to the visitor directly, but she'd pick it up and throw it in the bin. She told me that in Mawlynnong, children and adults clean the village daily. On Saturdays, the village leader **assigns** everyone extra 'social work' to be completed for the good of the village.



As we left for Shillong, the children smiled and waved at us happily.

Hoping to see you soon!

Your loving friend,

Janvi

To learn more about Meghalaya, you can scan the QR code:



Do You Know?

- Mawsynram in Meghalaya holds the record for receiving the highest rainfall.
- Krem Liat Prah in Meghalaya is India's longest natural cave.



- The Sacred Groves Forest in Meghalaya has some rare species of plants and animals.

Words to Know

impressed

spotlessly

thatched

stilts

machan

twisting

fashioned

rivulet

assigns

admire something or somebody because you think they are interesting

very clean

a roof made of dried grass and similar material

one of a set of wood or metal that support a building so that it is high above the ground or water

a platform erected in a tree

bending or curling something to distort its shape

made or gave shape to something, especially with one's hands

a small stream of water

gives someone a particular job to do



About the Story

A. Tick (✓) the correct option.

1. Mawlynnong was declared the cleanest village in Asia in _____.

a. 2003

☒

b. 2004

☐

c. 2008

☐

2. Janvi was impressed by the _____.

a. villagers greeting them warmly

☐

b. beauty and cleanliness of the village

☒

c. comfort of the guest house

☐

3. Janvi found sitting on the *machan* to be _____.

a. frightening

☐

b. exciting

☐

c. relaxing

☒

4. _____ is scared of heights.

a. Janvi

☐

b. Shray

☒

c. Mom

☐